

query. The search query can then be filtered using various criteria such as language, file format, date and query occurrences.

Search operators, which are prefixed to a query, are another great way of defining your results. Google has 10 major operators that can be used to retrieve pages from its cache, look for the query in URLs, search for links to the query, etc. Some useful search operators are 'related', 'allintitle' and 'indexof'. For example, if you are searching for the E3 games Web site, try entering the query as 'allinurl: E3 games'. This will give you results of all sites with 'E3' and 'games' in the URL.

If the search is OS specific, try using Google topic specific searches. The topics include Macintosh, Windows, BSD Unix and Linux. Another feature is an exclusive .edu (education) and .mil (military) site search. You could also narrow your search to a specific school using the university search, which provides a listing of many universities. You can check out all these advanced search features by clicking on the Advanced Search button or visiting www.google.com/advanced_search.

More than vanilla

Google is not about plain Web Searches; it also has a comprehensive image, news and directory search.

The image search is extremely effective, with algorithms that analyse various fac-



Before: Using a plain image search can result in thousands of useless images



After: The advanced image search will yield better and relevant results

Attention Web Masters

Searching is one thing and promotion is another. If you want to improve your site rankings in Google, just follow these simple steps.

If you wish to pay for promotion, use Google Adwords. This is a unique advertising system targetted at relevant customers. Check it out at www.google.com/ads/.

If you just want ranking improvements, you should follow the system Google uses to rank pages. Submit your site to the Open Directory Project, in order to get Google to list your site. Google provides more relevance to Directory based search results. Thus

tors, such as name of image and image caption. Images are then selected and processed, multiple instances are removed and finally the results are displayed as thumbnails. To refine image searches, try to restrict the resolution of the images. For example, to find 1,024 x 768 resolution images of natural beauty, search for 'nature 1024*768' rather than just 'nature'.

The 'Advanced Image Search' option, allows you to refine search results by searching for fixed file sizes, file format or colour values. You can also use the 'Safe Search' option to prevent explicit content from being displayed. To maximise your relevance, construct your query with keywords that may be included in the image or its caption.

A facet of the Internet that has been largely forgotten is Usenet. It is a system that transfers information inside specific groups, and can provide solutions and firsthand information from like-minded individuals around the world. It is considered to be the largest de-centralised source of information on the Internet. Google Group search can be used to track relevant information across Usenets. To do this, click on the Groups link.

When you search for Usenets, you must know the subject, the group or the author. When a search request is made, the results are displayed in a format similar to standard Web searches, but only



Use Google Group search to get exactly what you need, and nothing more!

a significant boost in ranking can be seen.

Also try to add all the keywords that define your site to the top or the Web address of your site. Google gives high priority to keywords in the title or heading of a page. Apart from this, spread the keywords along the entire page and site, as Google evaluates the content in the middle and at the bottom of your page.

Become a part of a Webring. Find a group of sites with related content. Provide cross links between the pages. This will result in link popularity and provide better results.

groups related to your query are shown. For a precise search of Usenet archives, use Advanced Search. Apart from standard filtering, the Advanced group search allows you to specify a group name, author and subject.

You will always find information on the Internet, but the problem is verifying this information. The Open Directory Project (ODP), started by Netscape, aims to solve this. It is a large catalogue of Web sites categorised by people around the world. These voluntary editors review sites, and decide whether they should be included in the directory. The directories are classified broadly into sections such as arts, business, computers, etc. Within these directories, are more specialised divisions that can be used to make search results precise. Due to the level of precision involved in Directories, an advanced search option is not necessary.

Google uses its search technology to track information from about 4,500 news sources, to form Google News. The news is then placed in order of relevance, allowing you to look at news from various sources and study different news perspectives. In a test search, Google retrieved a news item that was posted only 35 minutes earlier!



Google News is taken from over 4,500 sources and brought fresh to your desktop